

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: 1. Bona fides decision test

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1. Bona fides decision test

[1] Identify the decision actually taken

|

v

[2] Reconstruct facts known at that time

|

v

[3] Check prescribed rules and authority

|

v

[4] Test prudent-person plausibility

|

v

[5] Inspect reasons and due diligence

|

v

[6] Check conflict or personal benefit

|

v

[7] Separate outcome from decision process

|

v

[8] Classify error, negligence or misconduct

|

v

VERDICT -> A later loss is evidence to examine, not automatic proof of corruption.

ANSWER USE -> Use to open any good-faith-decision-gone-wrong answer.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: 2. ARC's two-sided vigilance failure

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2. ARC's two-sided vigilance failure

[1] Over-suspicion begins with bad outcome

|

v

[2] Whole decision chain is implicated

|

v

[3] Honest officers become risk-averse

|

v

[4] Investigative capacity loses precision

|

v

[5] Under-suspicion begins with captured safeguard

|

v

[6] Approval or secrecy creates delay

|

v

[7] Actual wrongdoers obtain protection

|

v

[8] Calibrated scrutiny corrects both sides

|

v

VERDICT -> Ethical vigilance must resist both harassment and institutional shielding.

ANSWER USE -> Use as the central thesis in a 15-mark analytical answer.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: 3. Screening and secret verification rail

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3. Screening and secret verification rail

[1] Receive complaint through secure channel

|
v

[2] Test specificity of alleged conduct

|
v

[3] Test credibility of source and facts

|
v

[4] Test verifiability through available records

|
v

[5] Preserve identity and evidence discreetly

|
v

[6] Use competent technical evaluation

|
v

[7] Record closure, escalation or investigation

|
v

[8] Permit supervisory review of delay

|
v

VERDICT -> Confidentiality protects persons; recorded review prevents invisible burial.

ANSWER USE -> Use for ARC paragraph 7.9 safeguards and complaint triage.

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4. Section 17A and Section 19

[1] 17A gate: pre-enquiry or investigation

|

v

[2] 17A nexus: official recommendation or decision

|

v

[3] 17A exception: on-the-spot undue advantage

|

v

[4] 17A risk: inquiry blocked too early

|

v

[5] 19 gate: court takes cognizance

|

v

[6] 19 scope: specified corruption offences

|

v

[7] Both require timely competent decision

|

v

[8] Neither converts sanction into acquittal

|

v

VERDICT -> The provisions protect at different stages and must never be collapsed.

ANSWER USE -> Use for a legal-ethical distinction in GS-IV or GS-II overlap.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: 5. From single directive to current uncertainty

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5. From single directive to current uncertainty

[1] Executive single directive protected senior ranks

|
v

[2] Vineet Narain annulled executive protection

|
v

[3] CVC Act inserted DSPE Act 6A

|
v

[4] Subramanian Swamy struck 6A in 2014

|
v

[5] PC Amendment inserted 17A in 2018

|
v

[6] 17A shifted from rank to conduct nexus

|
v

[7] Supreme Court split on 13 January 2026

|
v

[8] Official order referred matter for new Bench

|
v

VERDICT -> The old rank rule is gone; Section 17A's final constitutional status remains contested.

ANSWER USE -> Use for chronology and current-anchor accuracy.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: 6. Accountability of investigators

CENTRAL FOCUS

6. Accountability of investigators

[1] Protect operational independence

|
v

[2] Demand allegation and jurisdiction records

|
v

[3] Audit selective targeting or omission

|
v

[4] Test fabricated or suppressed evidence

|
v

[5] Review coercive delay and publicity

|
v

[6] Protect bona fide investigative judgment

|
v

[7] Provide independent complaint forum

|
v

[8] Publish anonymised accountability outcomes

|
v

VERDICT -> Watching investigators is compatible with independence when review targets abuse,
not outcomes.

ANSWER USE -> Use to explain ARC's proposed investigator-accountability unit.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: 7. Transfer industry and tenure protection

CENTRAL FOCUS

7. Transfer industry and tenure protection

[1] Political demand targets an honest refusal

|

v

[2] Posting becomes reward or punishment

|

v

[3] Repeated movement destroys continuity

|

v

[4] Informal retaliation avoids formal process

|

v

[5] Publish objective transfer policy

|

v

[6] Provide minimum tenure norms

|

v

[7] Record grounds for premature transfer

|

v

[8] Allow independent appeal and narrow exception

|

v

VERDICT -> Transfer reform protects neutrality without creating ownership of a post.

ANSWER USE -> Use in politicisation, non-partisanship and honest-official cases.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: 8. Written dissent implementation sequence

CENTRAL FOCUS

8. Written dissent implementation sequence

[1] Seek improper oral direction in writing

|

v

[2] Record facts, rules and public risk

|

v

[3] Disclose conflict and recuse if needed

|

v

[4] Use committee and published criteria

|

v

[5] State a reasoned written dissent

|

v

[6] Preserve records and access trails

|

v

[7] Escalate if the dissent is overridden

|

v

[8] Monitor residual risk after decision

|

v

VERDICT -> Conscience becomes administratively effective when converted into reasons, records and escalation.

ANSWER USE -> Use as the operational core of a Section-B answer.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: 9. Whistleblower protection ladder

CENTRAL FOCUS

9. Whistleblower protection ladder

[1] Verify concern and avoid reckless accusation

|

v

[2] Preserve documents lawfully and securely

|

v

[3] Use internal authorised vigilance channel

|

v

[4] Restrict and log identity access

|

v

[5] Assess safety and retaliation risk

|

v

[6] Escalate beyond captured management

|

v

[7] Use external disclosure only as last resort

|

v

[8] Seek remedy for adverse career action

|

v

VERDICT -> Effective voice requires safe routing, evidence discipline and remedies against reprisals.

ANSWER USE -> Use for the 2022 whistleblower PYQ and retaliation cases.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: 10. POSH due-process channel

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10. POSH due-process channel

[1] Receive written workplace complaint



[2] Constitute competent Internal Committee



[3] Protect confidentiality and participants



[4] Define allegations and preserve evidence



[5] Give respondent fair opportunity



[6] Complete impartial workplace inquiry



[7] Issue reasoned recommendations and action



[8] Keep criminal and vigilance routes distinct



VERDICT -> Protection of the complainant and fairness to the respondent are mutually necessary.

ANSWER USE -> Use where POSH is ignored, weaponised or mixed with corruption pressure.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: 11. Protection without impunity matrix

CENTRAL FOCUS

11. Protection without impunity matrix

[1] Bona fide risk receives process protection

|
v

[2] Specific credible complaint receives inquiry

|
v

[3] False publicity receives confidentiality control

|
v

[4] Credible delay receives independent review

|
v

[5] Honest investigator receives operational space

|
v

[6] Abusive investigator receives accountability

|
v

[7] Tenure receives recorded protection

|
v

[8] Proved misconduct receives lawful consequence

|
v

VERDICT -> Every safeguard must protect integrity while preserving a path to verified accountability.

ANSWER USE -> Use as a balanced conclusion rather than a one-sided immunity claim.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: 12. Examiner-ready answer spine

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12. Examiner-ready answer spine

- [1] Name the competing public values
 - |
 - v
- [2] Identify over-suspicion or shielding risk
 - |
 - v
- [3] Apply the bona fides process test
 - |
 - v
- [4] Add screening and verification safeguards
 - |
 - v
- [5] Separate 17A, 19 and adjudication stages
 - |
 - v
- [6] Add dissent, transfer and reporting remedies
 - |
 - v
- [7] Protect parallel POSH due process
 - |
 - v
- [8] Conclude with protection without impunity
 - |
 - v

VERDICT -> A high-quality answer joins ethical principle, named institution, action and qualification.

ANSWER USE -> Use to structure 10-, 15- and 20-mark responses.